REP-102 · Favoured Trade after the flip; a day on the table with each freshness option; should unsold fruit be thrown away?

Game	Fruit Market 1.19.1 live; rules version 18 being built (not released)
Report date	2026-11-12 (Asia/Kuala_Lumpur)
Type	Decision note and design options
Request	"go with B, for option 1&2 include also how process would flow when buying a new fruit with stocks from prior day in the shelf, returning fruits back to shelf if unsold? or should it just be simplified so thag unsold stocks are discarded? does it make sense"
Approval	Favoured Trade: option B approved (DEC-088, built in PLAN-079). Freshness tracking and the unsold-fruit question: open.

1. Favoured Trade: the three options and the choice

Option	For	Against
A. With your prices, before the flip (the app at rules 17)	Secret, simultaneous, fast; a real gamble	Often wasted when no tie happens: a free copy was worth about $0.39 a game in simulation
B. After the flip, when you see a tie (the printed guidebook)	Never wasted; easy to grasp; a stronger card	A pause after the flip; needs a rule for two tied holders; no bluff
C. Face down with your prices, taken back if none of your prices tied	Secret, never wasted, no extra step	One more line of rule

The owner chose **B**. How it will work, in the app and on the table (the details are my assumptions; say if any should differ):

1. When every price is face up, a stall that **holds the card and has a tied price** may play it. Nobody else is asked.
2. Tied holders decide **in today's buying order, in the open**. A later stall sees what an earlier one did.
3. If no holder is tied, the step does not happen: no pause, no extra tap.
4. The effect is unchanged: the stall wins every tied price that day. If two stalls in the same tie both play it, the usual order (fresher fruit, the Haggler, who bought first) decides between them and both cards are spent.
5. Online, the others see who is deciding. The table has the same tell. A stall that is away keeps its card.

It is being built into rules version 18 with the rest of PLAN-079. The build will measure how often the step happens and what a copy is now worth; if the card becomes the strongest favour, that comes back to the owner.

2. One day on the table with each freshness option

Mock-ups: https://claude.ai/artifact/GJQFbm98gEudhDf8HG5QnV (two new boards, "One day, step by step", under the two option boards). Both follow the same watermelon row through day 6: one piece kept back from yesterday, two bought today, two put on sale, one sold, one unsold, then night.

Step	Option 1 · slide the ruler	Option 2 · slide the fruit
Morning, with old stock	Yesterday's piece lies in column 5, where it was put when bought. The ruler above it reads F	Yesterday's piece slid one box left last night, to the second F box
Buy	New fruit goes into today's column (under the ruler's right edge). Old stock is not touched; old and new are in different columns	New fruit goes into the right-hand F box (green mango: the right-hand G box). Old stock is one box to the left
Buy an older piece from the market	Same column number as on the market board	Same letter and place as on the market board
Stock	Slide forward from the shelf row to the crate row, in the same column	Slide forward from the shelf to the tray, into the box in line
Bell	The shutter steps back behind the crate row. Rivals look from the piece up to the ruler	The tray slides past the shutter. Each piece lies on its own letter and colour
After the rush, unsold fruit	**Stays where it lies** in the crate row. The shutter goes back in front	**Stays on the tray**, which goes back behind the shutter
Night	One ruler slide per stall, done together and in the open. No fruit moves	Every piece one box left, on the tray, the shelf and the market, behind the shutter
Next morning	Leave the piece in the crate row or slide it back to the shelf	The same
Moves in this example	4 fruit moves and 1 ruler slide	6 fruit moves (a full shelf adds 8 a night)

Neither option needs a "return to the shelf" step. The app empties the crate every morning and the player fills it again; on the table that is the same as leaving unsold pieces where they are and letting the next Stocking slide pieces either way.

Exceptions each option still needs a line for: Heatwave (two columns or two boxes), Monsoon (no move), the Fridge card and Shade Cloth (option 1: those pieces move one column right; option 2: they skip the slide or go one box right), the Seconds Lorry (option 1: its fruit goes under the ruler's first O). With option 1 the columns count nights, not days: a Heatwave uses two, so the sheet needs one column for each night plus spares.

3. Should unsold fruit simply be thrown away?

Recommendation: **no**. There are two ways to read it, and neither removes the tracking.

Reading	What it would do
All fruit left at night is thrown away	Cannot work with the current game: every mango arrives green and needs two nights on the shelf; a standing order gives three buying turns to gather its pieces; the Fridge,

Reading	What it would do
	Shade Cloth, Juice Bar, Health Inspector, Heatwave and Monsoon, and every Okay and Soft price, exist only because fruit ages. The four fruits would differ only in price, against the aim that each fruit has its own way to play
Only crate fruit that was not sold is thrown away; the shelf keeps ageing	The shelf still has to be tracked, so nothing is saved. Losing a price fight would cost the sale and the fruit, so a stall that is behind falls further behind: the opposite of what the $5 top-up is for. Stalls would put out less, and customers already go short (53% to 71% of row demand is served at 3 stalls)

What the study shows about carried fruit (3 stalls, Normal computers, 2,800 games, `docs/studio/review-17/balance/BALANCE-FINDINGS.md` section 3): blueberries, watermelons and apples spend 0.27 to 0.28 nights on a shelf per piece, so roughly one piece in four is carried overnight; a mango spends 2.43 nights (two of them green); 30% of blueberries, 14% of watermelons, 5% of apples and 20% of mangoes are sold Okay.

Throwing fruit away would be a rule change for the app as well (the owner's standing rule is that table and app match), with a new rules version and a new balance study. Neither reading has been simulated.

4. Validation

Check	Result
Mock-ups opened and checked by eye	NOT RUN (canvas boards are not rendered here)
Either option printed and tried on a table	NOT RUN
"Throw unsold fruit away" simulated	NOT RUN (not recommended; can be run if the owner wants figures)
Favoured Trade after the flip built and simulated	NOT RUN (in progress, PLAN-079)

5. Open with the owner

1. Freshness tracking on the table: option 1 (ruler) or option 2 (tray).
2. Unsold fruit: keep it (recommended) or have a throw-away rule simulated.